

Is Chrome OS really a Cloud OS and how is it different?

For starters, Chrome OS comes pre installed only on Google's Chromebooks. They take about seven seconds to boot and you're ready to go. While Chrome, like any other Cloud OS requires a functioning internet connection to get any work done, the little space you have in its tiny SSD can be used to run Gmail, Docs and the media player in offline mode. You can also pick and choose a whole bunch of apps designed specifically for Chrome. Once you're back online, the applications sync and normality is restored.

But the fact that you can't exactly work on Chrome from the comforts of a random computer deep in the jungles of South America, sort or negates the one main distinction between a cloud based OS and a traditional OS.

But the fact that most of the apps that work offline are only a bunch of games and productivity tools, one wouldn't be wrong in calling Chrome OS a cloud OS. So what if it's available



Is this the future?

only on Chromebooks? It's merely following Google's tradition of an exclusive introduction before it goes commercial. Remember when Gmail was by invite only?

Secondly, Chromebooks are currently your only means of accessing Chrome OS could be because the hardware is designed keeping in check the basic specs needed to run it properly. While it may seem like a limit at the moment, in the near future, it could mean that Google might have spent the time in between perfecting a version of Chrome OS that does work on any old computer.

At the end of the day, you will have to agree that the fact that a few basic applications do run without the need for an internet connection gives you the best of both worlds. The fact that the device running it is streamlined to give you maximum performance sweetens it and finally, the fact that since you entire computer is the Chrome browser, using other cloud OSes is a cinch is the cherry on top. 